AMARINDER SINGH: People are going to look out for their tummies and jobs. Everyone wants money and the farmers certainly want more, the industrialists want more. Both industrial growth and agricultural growth are important and we need to come out with new ideas for that. We will have to make commitments for jobs—that's going to be our major thing.

Q. Why should people vote for you?

CHANNI: I have been informing my people about the reduced rates of electricity, water, petrol and diesel, and sand facilitated by my government, as well as the schemes launched to help start new businesses and the free bus rides provided to women and students. With so much work done in 111 days, I have become popular. If I get to work for a five-year term, imagine how much I can achieve. Anti-incumbency, if any, is against Captain Amarinder Singh, not the Congress. We are fortunate he left the Congress on his own. The sufferings of the Congress were because of him. By accepting him into their fold, the BJP has inherited that sentiment.

MANN: I am from among the people. I am not from a palace. To people, I am like their son or nephew—their very own. The Badals have huge walls in their palace; even a bird can't sit there



"Unemployment is the biggest issue and is causing brain drain. We want our students to get employment in Punjab"

BHAGWANT MANN

and chirp. My opponents call me a mere comedian. They are wrong—I am a satirist, a social critic. When I speak about cancer deaths, farmer deaths or corruption, are these jokes? These political parties have made a mockery of our country. We will give the people of Punjab an honest, transparent and well-intentioned government.

BADAL: Because of the development we ushered in while in power, we got every district of Punjab connected with good roads. All new power plants in the state were built during the Akali regime. Punjab needs a decisive leader. The chief minister is like a CEO of the state. People can rely on me for speedy development. We are the only Punjabi party—the rest are national parties and do not understand Punjab like we do. For instance, Arvind Kejriwal has written to the Supreme Court that thermal plants in Punjab be shut because they cause pollution. A national party will always have a clash of interest with the state.

AMARINDER: I offer experience. I have been in this game for 50 years and know what my state requires. I will not offer freebies for everyone, like Channi and the others are doing. That is absolute rubbish because where do you get the money for these sops from? When my government gave something, it was with a purpose, such as free health insurance. I will ensure both industrial and agricultural growth.

Q. What is your solution to the agricultural crisis in the state?

CHANNI: We need to switch to organic farming and get relief from pesticides and urea—the silent killers. We need to fix a separate MSP for organic crops. Then, all farmers will shift to organic farming and the health of our country will improve. We also need to diversify from rice to other crops since the water table in Punjab has been dropping alarmingly. If we leave barren lands for our future generations by depleting water, how will they survive? In order to improve this situation, we need to grow crops such as pulses, corn, etc. For that, the government needs to ensure higher MSP.

MANN: Guru Nanak said *uttam kheti* (farming is the best), *madhyam vyapar* (trade comes next), *neech naukri* (job is the worst). He gave agriculture top priority, whereas the reverse is happening now. Farming is no longer profitable. The central farm laws were repealed. We won this struggle. But farmers have been committing suicide even before these laws were introduced. The Punjab Agricultural University (PAU) should be at the centre of planning. We will strengthen it. We intend to create more awareness among farmers by employing two graduates in every village to provide the necessary knowledge. This will create at least 40,000 jobs. The other problem is paddy. To grow a kilo of paddy, 3,800 litres of water are required. This has caused a water crisis in



"Cheaper power, water, fuel; schemes to help start businesses... So much has been achieved in 111 days"

CHARANJIT CHANNI